Sun Protection and Skin Health

Simple habits help reduce sunburn and cumulative UV exposure

ABOUT THIS TOPIC

Ultraviolet radiation can cause sunburn and contributes to skin damage over time. Sunscreen is one part of protection; shade and clothing also matter. No sunscreen blocks all UV radiation.

Everyday care and treatment

- Choose broad-spectrum sunscreen with SPF 30 or higher. Water-resistant products can help during swimming or sweating; reapply according to the label.
- Use enough sunscreen to cover exposed skin, including ears, neck, and the backs of hands. Ask a health professional about use for infants.
- Seek shade when UV exposure is strongest and wear protective clothing, a wide-brimmed hat, and sunglasses when available.
- Avoid deliberate tanning and indoor tanning devices. Check skin for new or changing spots and ask a clinician about concerning changes.

WHEN TO GET HELP

Seek medical advice for severe sunburn, blistering over a large area, fever, dehydration, eye symptoms, or a mole or spot that changes, bleeds, or does not heal.

Sources for further reading

American Academy of Dermatology - Choosing the right sunscreen - https://www.aad.org/public/everyday-care/sun-protection/shade-clothing-sunscreen/choosing-right-sunscreen

American Academy of Dermatology - Understanding sunscreen labels - https://www.aad.org/public/everyday-care/sun-protection/shade-clothing-sunscreen/understand-sunscreen-labels

Reviewed for this educational handout: October 2026. Recommendations can change and depend on local guidance, age, pregnancy, other health conditions, and medicines. This handout is not a diagnosis or prescription.